clerk for fifteen years with no chance of breaking through the glass ceiling. Prejudice against Indians was so powerful and all pervasive that most did not recognize it as such. It was a given that no Indian could ever aspire to becoming an accountant or sub-accountant.

While Sorabji gained valuable practical experience, he soon realized that pragmatic self-education had its limits. He joined a book-keeping class held on Sundays and in due course passed the examination of the London Chamber of Commerce. Later, someone gave him a copy of the *Journal of the Institute of Bankers*, London, and Sorabji decided that his prospects in his chosen profession would receive a great fillip if he passed the Institute's examination.

His immediate concern was how to prepare for the Institute's examinations since there were no organized facilities for study. Sorabji was also handicapped due to his lack of educational qualifications. Fortunately for him in the same copy of the *Journal* he had been lent, there was an advertisement of a school in London which provided postal tuition. Sorabji contacted them and started to study in right earnest. Though Sorabji believed in learning by doing, his practical side convinced him that theoretical knowledge was also important. Unable to grasp this fact, his brothers and friends tried to dissuade him from pursuing such study by arguing that Sorabji with his sharpness and industry could learn all there was to be learnt at the bank's counter. But Sorabji was well aware of where his best interests lay, and while lending a willing ear to advice, did not hesitate to do things his own way. 'He believed in, and in himself came to symbolize, a combination of theory with practice, both being simultaneously pursued; and it can now be recognized that this, together with his personality, constituted the basis of his dynamic leadership.'[9]

Sorabji passed Part I of the examination in his first attempt, but the customary payment of £5 given to those who had passed the examination was denied to him since it was not intended for the bank's Indian branches. This blatant practice of racism took away some of the joy of his success and had a lasting impact on Sorabji. He also passed all the papers of Part II in his first attempt, except Political Economy, which was highly technical and which Sorabji had had no opportunity to study in a systematic manner. Subsequently his diligence ensured that he overcame this hurdle as well,